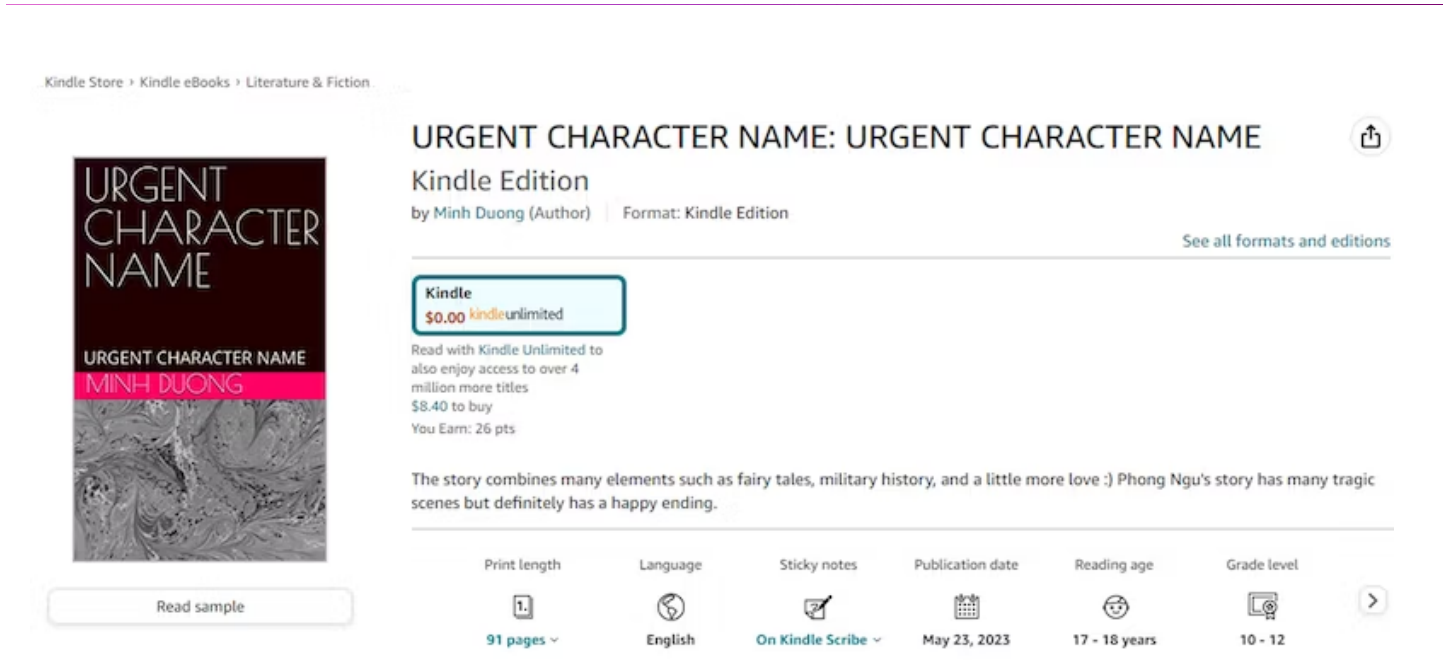




[Amazon/Kindle Store](#)

Amazon’s ebook charts are full of AI-generated spam

Authors are concerned that AI-generated ebooks may be gaming the system on Kindle Unlimited.

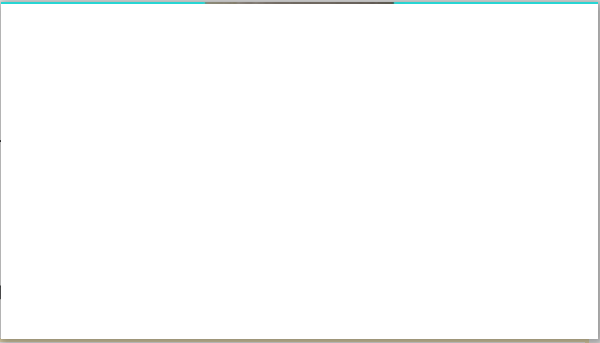


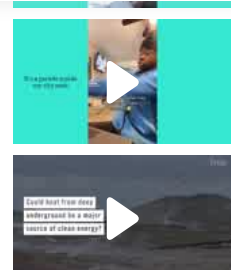
Gavia Baker-Whitelaw

Internet Culture

Posted on Jun 28, 2023 Updated on Jul 6, 2023, 3:41 pm CDT

Designed to “write an entire book for you in minutes” and then novel generator [gpt-author](#) attracted [immediate backlash](#) when





Featured Video

Not because authors were worried about being rendered obsolete by AI, but because they predicted this technology could overwhelm the ebook market with spam.

It looks like that's already happening. [ChatGPT ebooks](#) have already been around for a while, but this week several authors raised the alarm about AI-generated content appearing on Kindle's bestseller charts. Many of these ebooks flew under the radar for a couple of months but inexplicably gained traction in the past few days, sparking accusations of bot-farming.

The AI bots have broken Amazon.

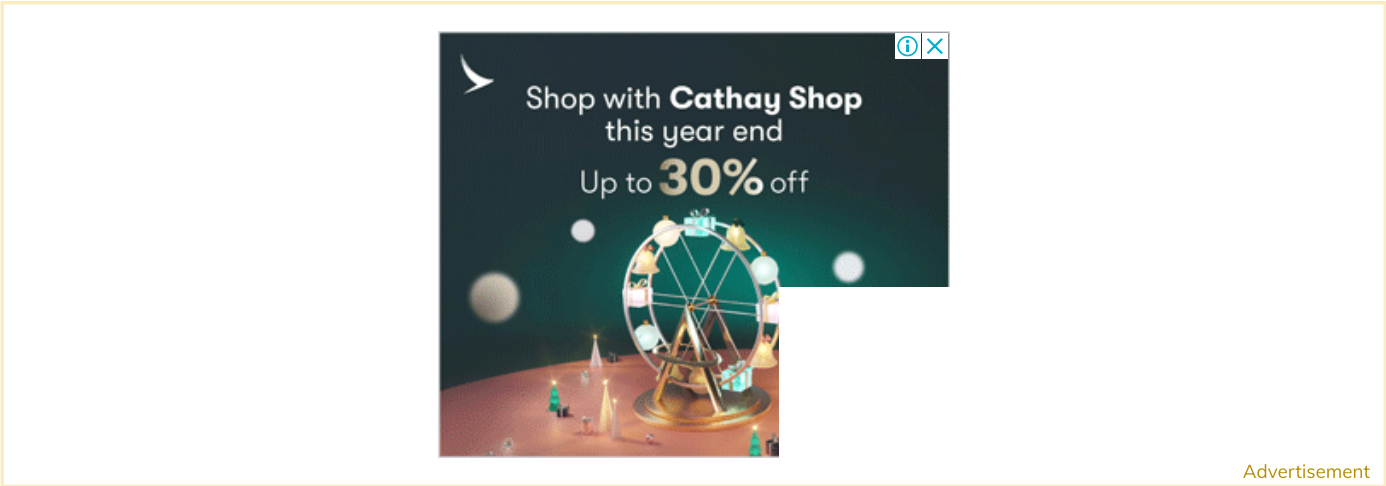
Take a look at the Best Sellers in Teen & Young Adult Contemporary Romance eBooks top 100 chart. I can see 19 actual legit books. <https://t.co/fy9rtV6Ck6>

The rest are AI nonsense clearly there to click farm. [@AmazonKDP](#) what are you doing about it? pic.twitter.com/cziuKcQrq3

— Caitlyn Lynch aka Catherine Bilson (@caitlynlynch6)

June 26, 2022





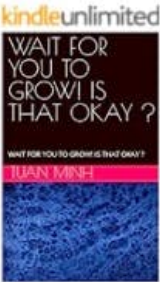
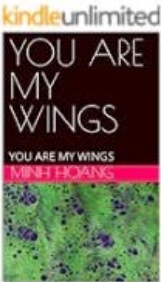
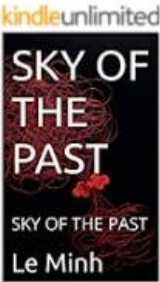
These AI-looking books are easy to spot, featuring bland covers with no relation to the genre at hand, and profiles with zero reviews and minimal plot summaries. For some reason, most are listed under Vietnamese author names, although there’s little evidence that these authors are real people.

Earlier this week, the top 100 bestsellers for contemporary teen romance included several seemingly AI-generated books. Those titles have since dropped off of Kindle Unlimited’s bestseller list, but they’re still available on the site, ranked between 100 and 300 in the genre.

Meanwhile, fake-looking ebooks are still going strong in [other subcategories](#) like military action fiction, [Hispanic American fiction](#), and [short two-hour reads](#), where you’ll find clusters of spam like this on the Kindle Unlimited bestseller lists:





 UNLIMITED POSSIBILITIES: UNLIMITED POSSIBILITIES Minh Hung Kindle Edition \$8.90	 THE COURT: THE COURT Chien Si Kindle Edition \$7.80	 AFTER ONE HAS ME: AFTER ONE HAS ME Minh Long Kindle Edition \$8.60
 #40 WAIT FOR YOU TO GROW! IS THAT OKAY ? Tuan Minh Kindle Edition \$7.50	 #41 YOU ARE MY WINGS: YOU ARE MY WINGS Minh Hoang Kindle Edition \$8.20	 #42 SKY OF THE PAST: SKY OF THE PAST Le Minh Kindle Edition \$8.10

Amazon

Of course, this invites a couple of obvious questions: Who is buying these books, and are they actually readable?

Why AI-generated books are charting on Kindle



Based on the sample excerpts for these ebooks, they're formatted with dialogue, and descriptive passages. Many resemble wuxia or xianxia novels. A few are even more generic. However, the text itself is mostly incoherent, and several books show identical plot



ebooks can earn money through subscriber pageviews rather than outright purchases.

This situation marks a real danger to the livelihoods of working authors. If the ebook market is flooded with spam, then it's harder for readers to find real books. It's already messing with Kindle's genre categories, creating even more roadblocks for self-published writers to cultivate an audience.

"We have clear content guidelines governing which books can be listed for sale and promptly investigate any book when a concern is raised," an Amazon spokesperson told the Daily Dot. "We invest heavily in funds, time, and company resources to provide a trustworthy shopping experience and protect customers and authors from abuse."



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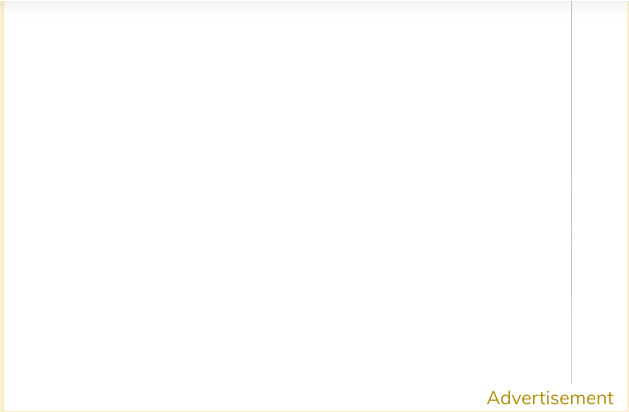
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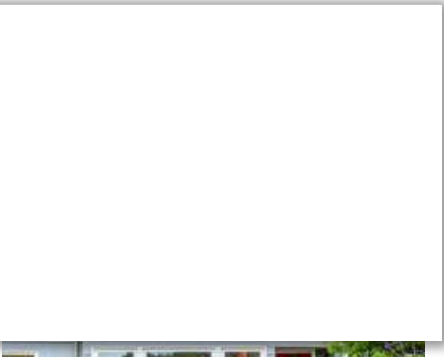
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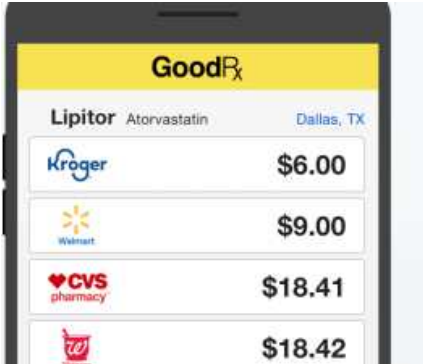


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